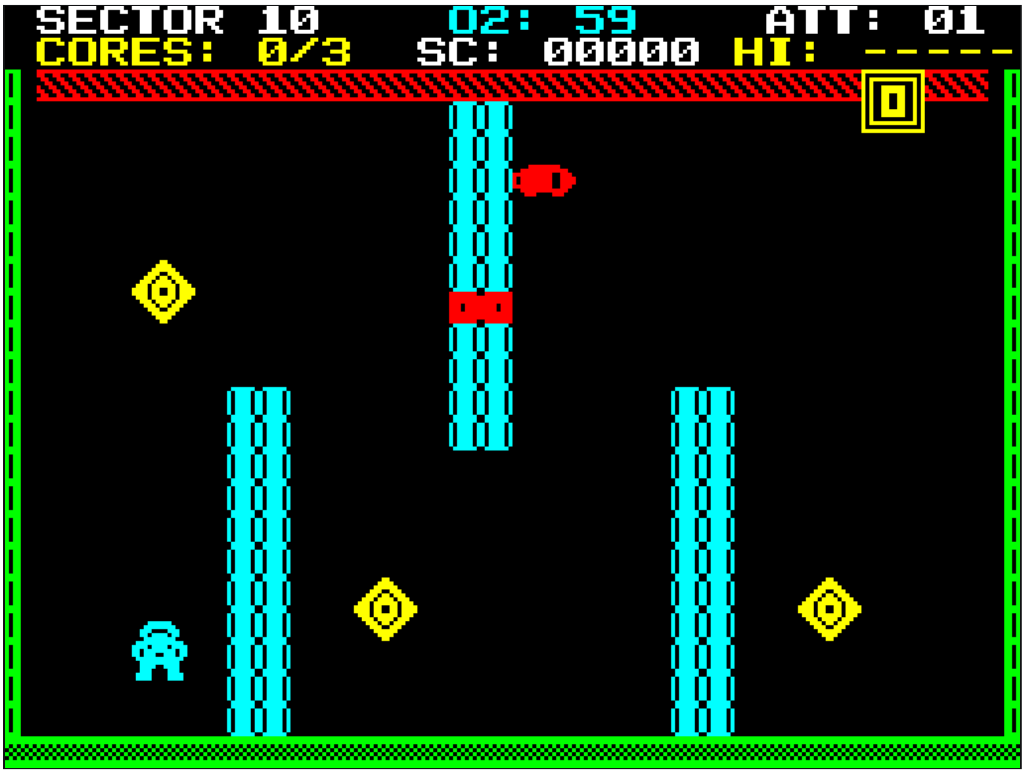
ANTI-GRAVITY

BUDGET TAPE

PUBLISHER	PRICE	MACHINE	CONTROLS
Dalex Software	£1.99 cass	SPECTRUM 128K	Keys

Gravity has gone the wrong way on the Helios-7 station, and everything, you included, wants to fall up into the red-hot ceiling. As a spacesuited engineer you hold A to thrust downwards, nudge O and P to drift left and right, and stamp on SPACE to brake your sideways slide. Each bay hides three yellow cores; grab all three and the hatch in the top corner flips from yellow to green so you can slip out. You get 59 seconds of air per go. There are ten sectors spread over three decks, with sweeping coolant lasers, patrolling sentry drones and pillar slaloms, and every cleared bay is graded S, A, B or C. It is very much in the spirit of Thrust, turned on its head.



▲ *Sector 10: three pillars, one laser and a drone in a hurry. Good luck.*



▲ *Three cores in, hatch gone green, and an S rank to show for it.*

REVIEWED BY

ZAK, PRU, GRIFF

ZAK

"Fab! Your spaceman jumps the instant you touch a key, and there is no slowdown or flicker even when a laser and a drone are both on the move. The later bays are dead tricky: Sector 10 has three pillars, a laser cutting across the middle and a drone that whizzes along twice as fast as the others. I chased S ranks right through all ten sectors and the Mission Complete tally, with my grade for every bay listed, was well worth seeing. For £1.99 this is a steal. Go on, buy it."

Z

ZAK SAYS **80%**

PRU

"I like a game that plays fair, and mostly this one does. The walls and floor are safe to scrape along, only the ceiling, the pillars and the nasties kill you, and R puts you straight back at the start of the bay. Two gripes, though. The oxygen readout stays the same calm blue right down to the last few seconds, so you can easily run out of air without noticing. And when you do die, the message box chops a stripe out of the scenery behind it until you have another go. Small things, but they niggle."

P

PRU SAYS **74%**



▲ *The tally at the end lists every sector's score and grade. Frame it.*



▲ *The title page spells out every key, so no excuses.*

GRIFF

"On the 128 there is a title tune and a separate ditty that runs while you fly, plus a steady stream of spot effects for thrusting, grabbing cores and getting killed. M turns the music off on the title page, though I got a little blip from the speaker when I flicked it. The graphics are clear rather than clever: chunky cyan pillars and yellow cores on black, and the drone turns a pillar red where it crosses. Neat and honest, if a bit plain."

G

GRIFF SAYS **68%**

THE LOWDOWN

CONTROL KEYS	A down-thrust, O/P left/right, SPACE brake, H pause, R retry, M music
USE OF COLOUR	Bold and clean on black, bar a red blotch where a drone crosses a pillar
GRAPHICS	Simple but clear, smooth and free of flicker
SOUND	128K title tune, in-flight ditty and plenty of spot effects
SKILL LEVELS	One, but ten sectors that get nastier as you go down the decks
SCREENS	Ten sectors across three decks
GENERAL RATING	A tough, tidy upside-down flier at a budget price

VERDICT

Falling upwards has never been so much fun: a budget flier with plenty of lift, despite a couple of rough edges.

THE RATINGS

PRESENTATION	77%
GRAPHICS	69%
SOUND	70%
PLAYABILITY	76%
ADDICTIVE QUALITIES	72%

OVERALL

THE MIDDLE OF THREE MARKS

